INDIA TODAY
www.indiatoday.in

CHAIRMAN AND EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Aroon Purie
VICE CHAIRPERSON: Kalli Purie
GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Dinesh Bhatia

GROUP EDITORIAL DIRECTOR: Raj Chengappa

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Manoj Sharma

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR: Nilanjan Das; **GROUP PHOTO EDITOR:** Bandeep Singh
EDITORS: Kai Jabir Friese (Features), Rajesh Jha (News)
MANAGING EDITOR: Sunil Menon
EXECUTIVE EDITORS: S. Sahaya Ranjit, Manisha Saroop; Mumbai: M.G. Arun
SENIOR DEPUTY EDITOR: Hyderabad: Amarnath K. Menon
DEPUTY EDITORS: Kaushik Deka, Shwweta Punj, Sasi Nair; Jaipur: Rohit Parihar
SENIOR EDITORS: Anilesh S. Mahajan, Ashish Mukherjee; Mumbai: Suhani Singh, Kiran Dinkar Tare; Patna: Amitabh Srivastava
SENIOR ASSOCIATE EDITORS: Sonali Acharjee; Kolkata: Romita Sengupta; Bhopal: Rahul Noronha
ASSISTANT EDITORS: Zinnia Ray Chaudhuri, Aditya Wig
PHOTO DEPARTMENT: Rajwant Singh Rawat, Chandra Deep Kumar (Principal Photographer), Mumbai: Mandar Suresh Deodhar (Chief Photographer)
PHOTO RESEARCHERS: Prabhakar Tiwari (Chief Photo Researcher), Saloni Vaid (Principal Photo Researcher)
CHIEF OF GRAPHICS: Tanmoy Chakraborty
ART DEPARTMENT: Sanjay Piplani (Deputy Creative Editor); Angshuman De (Art Director) Siddhant Jumde (Chief Illustrator)
PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: Harish Agarwal (Chief of Production), Naveen Gupta (Chief Coordinator)

ASSOCIATE PUBLISHERS
Vidya Menon (Impact)

IMPACT TEAM
National Head: Suparna Kumar (Government & PSU)
Senior General Manager: Jitendra Lad (West)
General Managers: Mayur Rastogi (North), Upendra Singh (Bangalore)
Deputy General Manager: Indranil Chatterjee (East)
GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: Vivek Malhotra

SALES AND OPERATIONS
Deepak Bhatt, Senior General Manager (National Sales)
Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations)
Rajeev Gandhi, Deputy General Manager (North)
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (West)
S Paramasivam, Deputy Regional Sales Manager (South)
Piyush Ranjan Das, Senior Sales Manager (East)

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Volume XLVII Number 16; For the week April 12-18, 2022, published on every Friday

● Editorial/Corporate Office Living Media India Ltd., India Today Group Mediaplex, FC-8, Sector-16A, Film City, Noida - 201301; Phone: 0120-4807100 ● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP)-201301; Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080; Mumbai: 022-66063411/3412, Kolkata: 033-40525327, Chennai: 044-24303200; e-mail: *wecare@intoday.com* ● Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, C-9, Sector-10, Noida-201301 (UP) ● Regd. Office: F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. ● Impact Offices: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One Indiabulls Centre, (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Phone: 66063355; Fax: 66063226 ● E-1, Ground Floor, Videocon Towers, Jhandewalan Extn, New Delhi ● Guna Complex, 5th Floor, Main Building, No.443, Anna Salai, Chennai-600018; Phone: 2847 8525 ● 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; ● 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; ● 6-3-885/7/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 ● 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 ; Fax: 2377059 ● 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 ● Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

Printed and published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana). Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. Editor: Raj Chengappa.

● INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

SYNDICATIONS TODAY INDIA DELIVERED
For **reprint rights** and **syndication** enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

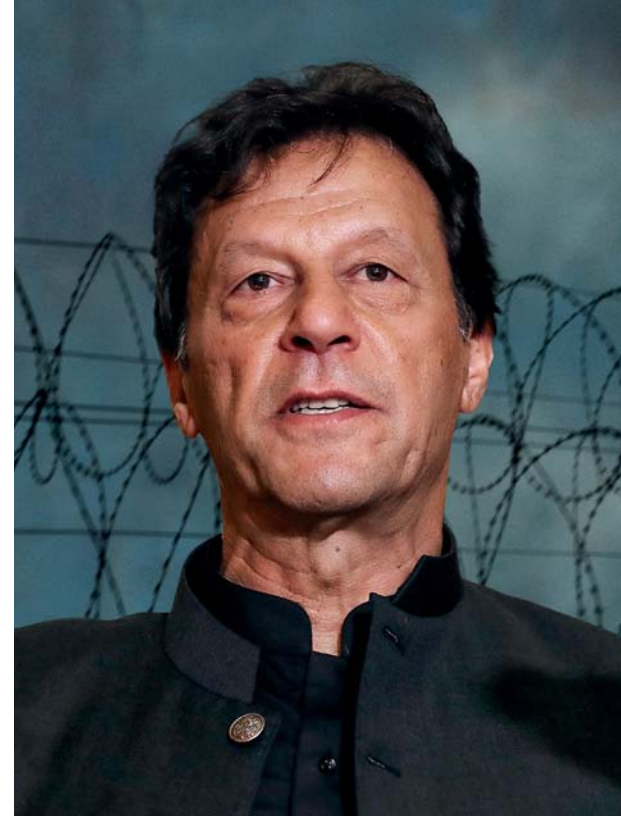


Photo Illustration by BANDEEP SINGH

26

IMRAN KHAN

DOWN BUT NOT OUT

Imran Khan has deflected the Pakistan opposition's attempt to oust him. Can a cocktail of charisma and rhetoric save a man whom the army has given up on?

INSIDE

UPFRONT

BJP: HEADMASTER MODI PG 6

AFSPA: BOOTS STRAPPED PG 10

LEISURE

DAISY ROCKWELL: TAKE HER WORD(S) FOR IT PG 62

Q&A WITH AMISH TRIPATHI PG 72

ARMS TRAFFICKING

36 COPS TURN GUNRUNNERS

Arrests of paramilitary personnel expose an arms supply chain for Maoist insurgents

KERALA/ K-RAIL

39 PINARAYI'S SILVER BULLET

Will the K-Rail SilverLine network project cement Pinarayi's legacy or ruin it?

WEST BENGAL

42 THE RIVER REFUGEES

Who is to blame for the thousands displaced by the Ganga's shifting course?

BUSINESS

47 HOW UDAY KOTAK FIXED IL&FS

His success in tackling the lender's bad debt could be a model for resolving financial crises

Note to the reader: From time to time, you will see pages titled 'An Impact Feature' or 'Focus' in INDIA TODAY. This is no different from an advertisement and the magazine's editorial staff is not involved in its creation in any way.

Cover photograph by **ANGELA WEISS/AFP**

INDIA TODAY GROUP

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301. Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India. Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com

E-MAIL to: **letters.editor@intoday.com** or log on to **www.indiatoday.in**